Preface

Imagine that you create a cool Rails web application that does different things for different users. To do so, your application needs to be able to identify users (at least users who are logged in versus anonymous visitors) to restrict its many functionalities. Before building your core Rails application logic, you will need a few authentication-related features working, that is, sign-up, sign-in, sign-out, remember me, and password reset features. In future, you will want to integrate the login with social networking sites such as Facebook or Twitter, so that your users will not need to retype all their details when signing up for, or signing in, to your web application.

You get so excited with your Rails web application idea that you start searching online for authentication solutions. Spending your time around the Internet, you find two choices; you can roll your own authentication or pick a gem that does authentication. After weighing these choices, you realize that you need a solution that works straight away. There are multiple gems that you can pick, such as Devise, Sorcery, and AuthLogic. Considering that you want to add a social networking sign in and manage user restrictions, you want the solution to work well with the features you will add in the future.

You can get Devise (`https://github.com/plataformatec/devise`), one of the most popular authentication solutions for Rails. It is a one-stop authentication solution that works right away. It also works neatly with other gems to help you with social networking sign in and restricting resources for different users.

In this book, you will find your all-in-one guide to learn implementation of user authentication using Devise. Through a series of hands-on instructions and code examples, this book will explain how Devise saves you from having to implement different types of authentication (for example, logging in, logging out, and password resets). You will learn how flexible, customizable, and testable Devise is. This book will also show you how using Devise, together with other gems, can help you define user privileges to restrict resources and integrate a social network login with your application.

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